

0.0350 mm

105.7 mg

9700 mL

Name: _____

Period: _____ Date: _____

Significant Figures & Precision

Main Idea	Notes																						
Uncertainty of Measurement	How “far out” can a measurement be made? No measurement instrument can measure to _____ A standard system of measurement is established that exactly shows the _____ of the instrument used to make the measurement. Measurement are made to _____ where the measuring device is marked. The precision of a measurement (_____) is indicated by the number of _____ recorded. 01 ↑ Device is <u>marked</u> to the ONES place. <u>Read</u> to the TENTHS place. 00.10.20.30.40.50.60.70.80.901.0 ↑ Device is <u>marked</u> to the TENTHS place. <u>Read</u> to the HUNDRETHS. 0102030405060708090100 Device is <u>marked</u> to the TENS place. <u>Read</u> to the ONES place. ↑ By reading the measurement, you can envision the markings on the _____ that was used. 56.7 cm The measurement instrument had marks to the _____ place. 97.755 g _____ place.																						
	Precision	<table><thead><tr><th></th><th>Precision</th><th>Smallest Mark on Measuring Instrument</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>12.050 cm</td><td>_____</td><td>_____</td></tr><tr><td>5.15 mL</td><td>_____</td><td>_____</td></tr><tr><td>0.0070 g</td><td>_____</td><td>_____</td></tr><tr><td>72.325 s</td><td>_____</td><td>_____</td></tr><tr><td>0.900 mg</td><td>_____</td><td>_____</td></tr><tr><td>35.0 cm</td><td>_____</td><td>_____</td></tr></tbody></table>		Precision	Smallest Mark on Measuring Instrument	12.050 cm	_____	_____	5.15 mL	_____	_____	0.0070 g	_____	_____	72.325 s	_____	_____	0.900 mg	_____	_____	35.0 cm	_____	_____
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Significant Figures & Precision

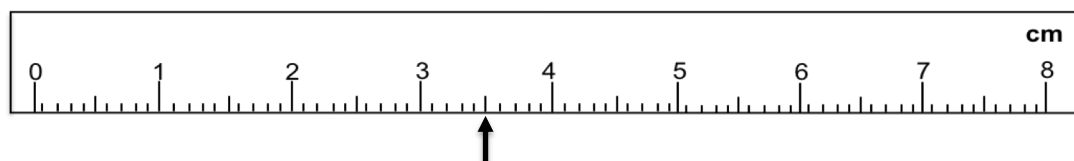
Main Idea	Notes		
Significant Figures	Significant figures () are digits that are actually (certain digits) ending with the last digit that is (). Sig Figs = all digits and one digit. The purpose of sig figs is to of the measurement.		
Rules for Counting Sig Figs	1. All digits are significant. 2348 = sig figs 175,348 = sig figs	2. Imbedded zeros count as sig figs. 16.07 = sig figs 20,034 = sig figs This just leaves the zeros to deal with!	
	3. Leading zeros <u>DO NOT</u> count as . 0.04863 = sig figs 0.001 = sig figs	4. Trailing zeros are significant only if the number contains a . 2.800 = sig figs 23.0 = sig figs 245.150 = sig figs	
	Placeholder zeros: zeros that must be present to give to the . (keeps digits in the right place value) Placeholder zeros ARE NOT significant! 1000 = sig figs What about this measurement? 203,000 What if we need to show the precision to the hundreds place, or the tens place, or the ones place? 0.00570 = sig figs Trailing zeros in a number larger than 1, are significant ONLY if they are followed by a decimal, or come before a zero with a line over it (include zero with the line).		
	Scientific Notation ONLY contains significant figures! 203,000 = 203,000 = 203,000 =	Instead of putting a line over the last significant zero, you can use scientific notation to show all sig figs. 800,000 = 8.00 x 10 ⁵ =	
Practice!	How many sig figs are in each of the following measurements? 4.0070 m _____ 27.50 L _____ 7,002,800. g _____ 15.10 x 10 ³ cm _____ 0.000670 m _____ 1,200,000 μm _____ 800,000 mg _____	TIP! Start counting with the first NON-ZERO on the LEFT, and count to the right.	
		0.0205 mg 35,000 mg	
		Numbers larger than ONE: Start with first non-zero and count to the decimal, line, or to the end if decimal is present.	
		35,000. mg 35,000 mg 35,000.15 mg	
	0.17 mm _____ 0.0030 mL _____ 0.0900 L _____ 0.100 cm _____ 0.00008 km _____ 0.012300 g _____	24300 nm _____ 150,000 ppm _____ 4700. g _____ 49.0 km _____ 23.070 mg _____ 70.000 g _____ 8.10 x 10 ⁻⁵ g _____	43.8 g _____ 2550 cm _____ 470 mL _____ 5.4070 x 10 ⁻² L _____ 0.0075000 kg _____ 65,000,000 mg _____ 940,000. ppm _____

True or False

- ___ 1. Significant figures are used to show the precision of a measurement.
- ___ 2. Placeholder zeros are always significant.
- ___ 3. A correctly recorded measurement ends with an estimated digit.
- ___ 4. Imbedded zeros are not significant.
- ___ 5. In scientific notation all of the digits in the base number are significant.
- ___ 6. Leading zeros are always significant.
- ___ 7. A line over a zero indicates that it is the last significant digit.
- ___ 8. Trailing zeros to the right of the decimal are always significant.
- ___ 9. The number 550,000. has 6 sig figs.
- ___ 10. The number 0.00570 has 6 sig figs.

Short Answer

11. Explain the importance of using significant digits. _____



12. Correctly record this measurement. _____ How many sig figs does this measurement have? _____

13. Describe a placeholder zero. _____

How many sig figs?

Determine the number of sig figs for each of the following measurements.

Round the following measurements to the specified number of sig figs.

14) _____ 0.0120 m

19) _____ 5,487,129 m to three sig figs

15) _____ 100.5 mL

20) _____ 31,947.972 cm² to four sig figs

16) _____ 350. cm²

21) _____ 192.6739 cm³ to five sig figs

17) _____ 1000 kg

22) _____ 786.09164 cm to two sig figs

18) _____ 0.0020700 dm

Determine the number of sig figs for each of the following measurements.

Round the following measurements to the specified number of sig figs.

23) _____ 0.000150 L

27) _____ 35.27 cm to three sig figs

24) _____ 998,870 cm³

28) _____ 1.35 m to two sig figs

25) _____ 1.000 x 10⁴ kg

29) _____ 78,000,000 nm to four sig figs

26) _____ 23,500 mg

30) _____ 350.275 cm to three sig figs